Finance Flexee V3

Accounting Election Control & Student Workflow

Functional change specification — Faculty-controlled optional workflow

1. Purpose

Introduce an optional Accounting Election Control setting at the course/simulation level. When enabled by faculty before deployment, students may either continue with the simulation's default accounting settings or propose changes to the accounting methods. A proposed change requires faculty approval or rejection. When the feature is disabled, the existing/default simulation workflow remains unchanged.

2. Core Business Rule

Faculty setting	Student behavior	Faculty action
OFF / Disabled	Student continues using the configured/default accounting settings. No accounting-method change workflow is pre	
ON / Enabled	Student chooses either Use Default Accounting Settings or Change Accounting Settings and proposed ch	Only if the student submits a pro-

3. Faculty Configuration

Add a new option to the faculty course/simulation configuration before deployment.

Recommended label: Enable Student Accounting Election

Description: Allow students to select different accounting methods in Quarter 4 and submit proposed changes for faculty review.

Configuration values:

• **Disabled (default):** Use the existing simulation/default accounting behavior.
• **Enabled:** Present the student with the choice to keep defaults or request accounting-method changes.

Deployment rule: The faculty choice is made before the course is deployed. After deployment, the configuration should be treated as part of the deployed simulation configuration.

4. Student Workflow When Feature is OFF

This path must preserve the existing simulation experience.

1	Q4 opens
2	Default/configured accounting settings remain in effect
3	No accounting-method change request is required
4	Student continues with the normal Q4 decision workflow

5. Student Workflow When Feature is ON

The student is given a choice rather than being forced to change accounting methods.

Q4	Accounting settings choice is displayed.
Option A	Use Default Accounting Settings — student continues without requesting a change.

Option B	Change Accounting Settings — student selects proposed accounting methods and submits them for fa
Pending	If a change is submitted, the request becomes read-only while awaiting faculty review.
Approved	Approved methods become the student's selected accounting methods.
Rejected	Original/default accounting settings remain in effect.
Continue	Student proceeds with the Q4 decision workflow according to the applicable accounting-election status.

6. Accounting Methods Available for Change

Method	Student-selectable?
Depreciation Method	Yes
Shipping Terms	Yes
Bad Debt Method	Yes
Warranty Method	Yes
Excise Tax Treatment	Yes
Inventory Method	No — fixed to FIFO

7. Faculty Review

Faculty approval/rejection is required only when the student chooses to change accounting settings and submits a proposed change. The faculty review screen should therefore contain only requests generated by students who selected the change path.

Approve: Accept the student's proposed accounting-method changes.
Reject: Decline the proposed changes and retain the original/default settings.

There should be no faculty approval step for students who choose the default settings.

8. Student UI States

State	Expected UI
Feature OFF	No new change-request workflow. Student follows existing/default behavior.
Feature ON — choice pending	Student sees Default vs Change choice.
Default selected	Show confirmation and allow the student to continue.
Change selected	Show the five selectable accounting methods; FIFO remains locked.
Pending faculty review	Show pending status and prevent modification of the submitted proposal.
Approved	Show approved status and the accepted methods.
Rejected	Show rejected status and indicate that original/default methods remain.

9. Backend / Architecture Requirements

The feature must be enforced server-side as well as through the UI. A disabled or pending state must not be bypassable by directly calling a route or Livewire action.

Recommended implementation principles:

• Add a course-level feature flag for the faculty configuration.
• Default the flag to **false** so existing simulations retain their behavior.
• Keep the existing accounting-election validation and calculation architecture.
• Do not make the new workflow mandatory for courses where the faculty setting is OFF.
• Keep Inventory Method fixed to FIFO.
• Only create a faculty review item when a student actually submits a proposed change.
• Do not duplicate accounting calculation logic inside the new workflow.

10. Implementation Sequence

1	Add faculty course configuration flag, default OFF.
2	Persist the setting through course creation/configuration and deployment.
3	Expose the setting on the faculty configuration screen before deployment.
4	Add the student Q4 Default vs Change choice when the feature is ON.
5	Keep the existing/default student path unchanged when the feature is OFF.
6	Implement the student accounting-method proposal submission.
7	Connect submitted proposals to the faculty review screen.
8	Implement approve/reject behavior.
9	Connect the approved/default result to the existing accounting-election engine.
10	Apply/verify the Q4 decision gating rules for the enabled workflow.
11	Test OFF and ON paths separately, including direct-route/backend bypass attempts.

11. Acceptance Criteria

1. Faculty can enable or disable Accounting Election Control before deployment.

2. The default value is OFF.

3. OFF courses continue through the existing/default accounting workflow without additional approval steps.

4. ON courses give each student a choice between keeping defaults and proposing accounting-method changes.

5. Choosing defaults does not create a faculty approval request.

6. Choosing Change allows the student to select the five permitted methods.

7. Inventory Method is always FIFO and cannot be changed.

8. A submitted change proposal cannot be edited while pending faculty review.

9. Faculty can approve or reject only actual student-submitted change proposals.

10. Approval applies the proposed accounting-method choices; rejection retains the original/default settings.

11. The feature cannot be bypassed through direct URLs or Livewire/service calls.

12. Existing accounting calculation logic is preserved.

12. Important Correction to the Current Prototype

The current prototype was temporarily changed so that Q4 accounting elections were mandatory before saving a decision. Under the revised business requirement, that rule must be conditional on the faculty feature setting and the student's selected path. It should not remain a universal mandatory election gate.

The implementation should therefore be adjusted before finalizing the Q4 decision-save/submit behavior.

Document purpose: implementation reference for the Finance Flexee V3 development workflow.